Dhāraṇī of the Essence of the Gaṇḍavyūha

Toh 941 · Derge Kangyur

The Heart of the Noble Gaṇḍavyūha is a very brief dhāraṇī text, a short Sanskrit incantation said to condense the vast Gaṇḍavyūha Sūtra, the scripture that recounts the pilgrimage of the youth Sudhana in search of awakening. In Tibetan it is known by a title meaning "the heart of the noble Gaṇḍavyūha," and its Sanskrit form would correspond to a Gaṇḍavyūha heart or essence, though the exact Sanskrit title is not stated in the opening lines. After an homage to the Three Jewels, the text gives a single mantra invoking the unobstructed teaching of the buddhas and the arising of the tathāgatas. It then promises that whoever upholds this mantra will have effectively read and recited the entire Gaṇḍavyūha Sūtra, and will come to know the maṇḍalas, the sacred commitments, and the mudrās of both worldly and transcendent traditions. It is Toh 941 in the Kangyur, where it belongs among the collected dhāraṇī texts.

Homage to the Three Jewels.

namaḥ smantā bujñānaṃ apratihata śāsanānāṃ oṃ kiṇi kiṇi tathāgata udbhava śānte varde uttama uttama tathāgata udbhava hūṃ phaṭ svāhā

By upholding this, one will have read and recited the entire Noble Gaṇḍavyūha Sūtra in full. One will come to know the maṇḍalas and the sacred commitments of everything worldly and transcendent. One will also come to know the mudrās.

The Heart of the Noble Gaṇḍavyūha is complete.

Translator's Notes

• The closing word is written □□□□□□□□□, which is evidently a slip for the usual concluding formula □□□□□□□□, "is complete"; it has been translated accordingly.

Colophon

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spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.